

An Opinion Piece



Lesson Overview

Category	Information
Level	B2
Language	English
Aim	Develop learners' ability to write an opinion piece about a social media issue using modal and phrasal verbs.

Learning Objectives

After completing this content, you will be able to:

- Understand and use a variety of phrasal verbs in context.
- Use modal verbs to give advice.
- Write a short opinion piece expressing your opinion and giving advice.

Let's get started!

1. Discuss

Discuss with your partner:

- Do you **look up** to anyone online?

2. Reading : The Problem with Social Media

Read the text below. Try to mark the following sections: Introduction, main body, and conclusion.

Social media is a huge part of teenagers' lives today. We use apps to **keep up** with friends, watch videos, and share our opinions. However, I believe social media can cause problems if we do not use it carefully. Firstly, privacy is often overlooked. When **setting up** your profile, make it private, so only people you know in real life can see what you post. You shouldn't publish your location, or use your full name in your username, as this information could **end up** in the wrong hands. Another problem is fake news. On social media, false information can **blow up** very quickly. You must be careful before believing everything you see. You can look up information on trusted websites to check if something is true before sharing it with others. In conclusion, although social media can be entertaining, you should use it responsibly, and if you need a break, you can always **log off**.

3. Comprehension Questions

1. Is the author's opinion of social media generally positive or negative? Why?
2. Do you agree with the author's opinion?

4. How to write an opinion piece

An opinion piece can be divided into 3 parts.

1. Introduction
2. Main body / Argument
3. Conclusion

Introduction

In the introduction, you should include

1. A line introducing the topic. Some examples include:
 - The topic of ... has been widely discussed in recent years.
 - In recent years, there has been a lot of debate about ...
 - ... Nowadays, many people have different opinions about ...
 - ... has become an important issue in modern society.
2. A line briefly stating your opinion, without justification.
 - I believe...

- In my opinion...
- From my perspective...

Main Body / Argument

In this section, include your main argument(s). Provide examples or evidence to support your opinion. You can use the internet to research. eg:

- A study found that 80% of students...
- For example, Facebook has over 2 billion daily users...

Conclusion

Finally, in the conclusion, you summarise your opinion in one or two lines. You can use the following connectors to introduce your conclusion:

- Finally...
- In summary...
- To sum up...
- At the end of the day...

5. Writing an opinion piece

Your turn!

Write a short opinion piece with an **introduction**, **main body** and **conclusion** about the topic:

Are social media influencers good role models?

Your text must be between 100-120 words, and include:

- At least 2 phrasal verbs
- At least 3 modal verbs

Let's get started!